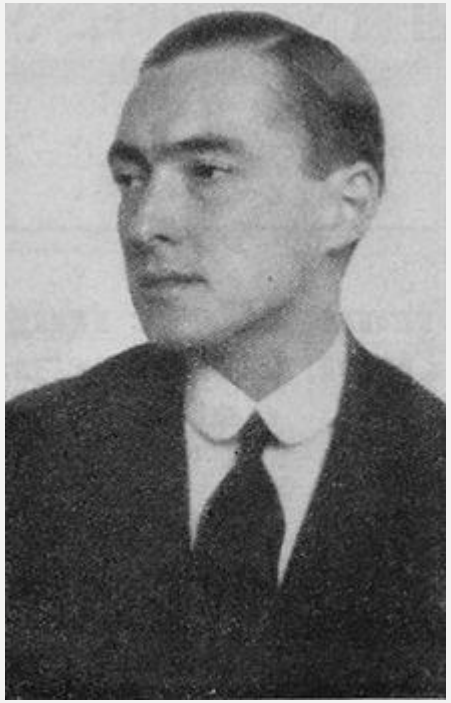
ORIGINS AND VISIONARIES 1945/1948

SEEDS OF UNITY BEFORE 1945: A CONTINENT IN TURMOIL

- Europe devastated by two world wars, nationalism discredited
- Intellectuals and politicians sought new frameworks to prevent future conflict
- Early ideas of cooperation and federation emerged amid rising tensions

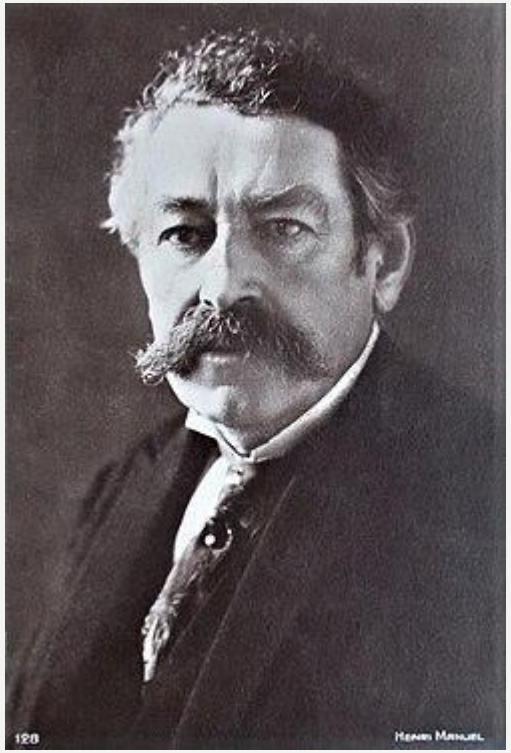
COUNT RICHARD VON COUDENHOVE-KALERGI: THE PIONEER OF PAN-EUROPEANISM

- 1923: Founded the Pan-European Movement advocating a united Europe
- Published "Pan-Europa" manifesto promoting political and economic integration
- Vision: a peaceful Europe transcending nationalism through federalism
- Influenced European elites and inspired later integration efforts



ARISTIDES BRIAND'S 1929 PROPOSAL FOR A EUROPEAN FEDERAL UNION

- French Foreign Minister Briand proposed a "European Federal Union" to the League of Nations
- Aimed to create a framework for economic cooperation and peace
- Though unrealized, it marked the first official political call for European unity
- Set precedent for supranational cooperation beyond nation-states



WINSTON CHURCHILL'S 1946 ZURICH SPEECH: "UNITED STATES OF EUROPE"

- Delivered September 19, 1946, advocating a united Europe to secure peace
- Called for a "Council of Europe" to foster cooperation among European nations
- Emphasized reconciliation, especially Franco-German friendship
- Though Britain initially stayed aloof, Churchill's vision influenced European leaders

STEFAN ZWEIG: THE WORLD OF YESTERDAY: MEMOIRES OF A EUROPEAN

- *The World of Yesterday* by Stefan Zweig is more than a personal autobiography; it is a historical and emotional testimony of a Europe that disappeared in the first half of the twentieth century.

1. What emotions dominate these fragments, and how are they connected to the historical events taking place in Europe at the time?
2. How does Zweig define or suggest a concept of "European identity" in these texts and how does this identity differ from national or political identities?
3. What idea of a unified Europe emerges from these fragments, and to what extent is it presented as a lost dream, a moral ideal, or a possible future project?
4. 4. Does Zweig's nostalgia for pre-war Europe idealize the past, or does it function as a critical tool to warn future generations about political and moral decline?

WAR, SORROW, BORDERS, NATIONALISM, ESTRANGEMENT, UNSECURITY, HATE

EUROPEAN DREAM: PEACE, HAPPINESS, MOBILITY, SUPRANATIONALISM, BELONGING, SECURITY…

THE IMMEDIATE POSTWAR CONTEXT (1945–1948): DEVASTATION AND URGENCY

- Europe in ruins: cities destroyed, economies shattered, millions displaced
- Cold War tensions rising; Europe divided into Western and Soviet spheres
- Urgent need for economic recovery and political stability
- Western European leaders sought new forms of cooperation to rebuild and secure peace

EARLY INTEGRATION IDEAS IN 1946–1948: FOUNDATIONS FOR THE ECSC (COAL & STEEL)

- 1946: French Prime Minister Georges Bidault proposed a European customs union
- 1947: The **Marshall Plan** fostered economic cooperation and US support for European unity
- 1948: **The Treaty of Brussels** created Western Union for defense cooperation
- These initiatives built trust and practical cooperation among Western European states
- First institutional step for political cooperation: 1949. The Council of Europe

THE COUNCIL OF EUROPE (1949): FIRST INSTITUTIONAL STEP

- Founded in 1949 to promote human rights, democracy, and rule of law
- Included 10 founding members, including Britain and France
- Not a supranational body but a forum for dialogue and cooperation
- Laid groundwork for deeper integration efforts

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rl3gtHtJrL4

CONCLUSION: THE VISIONARIES WHO LAID EUROPE'S FOUNDATIONS

- Early 20th-century thinkers planted the idea of a united Europe amid conflict
- Postwar leaders translated vision into concrete cooperation frameworks
- Their legacy endures in today's European Union, a unique peace project born from crisis
- European integration remains a testament to the power of ideas and collaboration to transform history